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Intermediate Team Faculty

Mary, Star of the Sea School

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Syllabus: 2026-2027 Grade 5 Religion

Mary, Star of the Sea School Mission

Nurture, Unite, Inspire. We are committed to nurturing each child's curiosity, uniting our classroom in respect and collaboration, and inspiring every student to grow in knowledge, faith, and wonder for the world around them.

2026-2027 Essential Question

"How can I model kindness, fairness, and humility like Jesus?"

Welcome to Grade 5! I am excited to partner with you this school year. This syllabus outlines what we will learn, classroom expectations, grading policies, and the support you can expect throughout the school year. We will work together to create a class community where every student is encouraged, challenged, and inspired to grow academically and spiritually.

Schoolwide Learning Expectations (SLEs): Self-Aware, Confident Individuals; Teachable Life-Long Learners; Active Christians; Responsible Citizens

Religion Course Overview:

Students in Grade 5 Religion at MSOS will grow in their relationship with God and gain an understanding of the importance of each individual as part of the Church's mission.

Textbook: *Blest Are We: Faith in Action*

CURRICULUM:

- Quarter 1: The Sacraments
- Quarter 2: Initiation & The Apostles Creed
- Quarter 3: Eucharist & The Last Supper
- Quarter 4: Forgiving & Living as Christians

RELIGION GRADING POLICY:

- 20% Homework / Classwork / Notes
- 30% Projects
- 30% Tests
- 10% Quizzes
- 10% Participation

*Parents, please note: You will have access to my electronic grade book via your Beehively account, which will be the method of communicating your child's academic performance. Beehively will serve as the primary source for monitoring grades, missing assignments, and academic progress throughout the school year.

REQUIRED MATERIALS:

Students should bring the following materials to Religion each day:

- Children's Bible
- Composition Book
- Erasable pen, pencil, eraser, and highlighter
- School-issued iPad (with access to Google Classroom)
- School planner

SUPPLEMENTAL MATERIALS — TEXTBOOKS:

- Blest Are We Second Edition: Faith in Action
- The Catholic Children's Bible

HOMEWORK POLICY:

As per school policy, students are expected to allocate up to 50 minutes of homework per night. Your child's 5th-grade teachers will work together to ensure that students receive a balanced homework regimen that fosters a positive learning environment and nurtures their intellectual growth. Students are expected to record assignments daily in their school planner. Homework and important reminders will also be posted on Google Classroom for students and families. Parents are expected to check the student's planner daily, support their child in time management, and follow through.

Late work will be accepted; however, submitting assignments on time is an important part of developing responsibility. Late submissions may negatively affect a student's participation grade.

CLASSROOM EXPECTATIONS:

- Students come to class prepared and ready to learn each day.

- Homework should be completed on time. If circumstances prevent completion, students should communicate with the teacher in advance so that an appropriate plan can be made.
- Everyone is encouraged to participate by asking questions, contributing ideas, and seeking clarification from the teacher when needed.
- We will treat ourselves, one another, and school property with respect and responsibility.
- Class Incentives: Individual Treasure Box visit, class community rewards

Class Consequences:

- Step 1: Verbal reminder
- Step 2: One-on-one discussion, written self-reflection
- Step 3: Parent contact

Important Dates:

- Parent Orientation Night: August 12, 2026

Parent-Teacher Conferences:

- Fall: September 10–11, 2026
- Spring: February 19, 2027 (optional)

Expeditions:

- Q1 — Coconut Island: September 28, 2026
- Q2 — Pearl Harbor: November 17, 2026
- Q3 — 'Iolani Palace: March 5, 2027
- Q4 — Niu Valley Hike: June 1, 2027
- School Spelling Bee: November 20, 2026
- Christmas Performance: December 18, 2026
- End-of-Year Awards: June 3, 2027

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY:

Honesty and integrity are essential values in our classroom. Teachers have the responsibility to:

- Structure conditions during testing to alleviate the possibility of cheating
- Specify the types of collaboration that are discouraged and those that are encouraged
- Teach students the summarization of material and the distinction between summarizing and copying straight from the text

Students have the responsibility to:

- Avoid situations that might contribute to cheating or plagiarism
- Avoid unauthorized assistance
- Use sources in the prescribed manner outlined by the teacher

ABSENCES AND TARDINESS

Students may remain at home in the case of illness, accident, quarantine, or because of a death in the family.

The teacher will help the student make up for missing assignments after a short absence. When the absence is expected to be prolonged, families must notify the teacher so that a plan can be developed to complete any missing work. Repeated or prolonged absences may impede the student's academic progress and possibly the student's right to continue attending.

Students are marked tardy after the 7:45 a.m. bell rings. Explanatory notes from parents and conferences with parents may be advisable.

FOOD AND DRINK

- Food is prohibited in the classroom unless otherwise specified by the teacher.
- Sharing food is not permitted to ensure adherence to dietary restrictions.

TECHNOLOGY

- To minimize distractions and maximize learning, communication with students during the school day should be limited to emergencies.
- Student cell phones must remain off and in backpacks for the duration of a school day.
- This policy also applies to student smartwatches (e.g., Apple Watches, Gizmos, Fitbits).

If a student is in violation of this policy, the discipline will be as follows:

- 1st Time Offense — Warning
- 2nd Time Offense — Phone will be sent to the office for student pick up from the Principal
- 3rd Time Offense — Phone will be sent to the office for student pick up from the Principal and parent will be notified

TEACHER CONTACT

- Contact me via email: asoto-gelacio@starofthesea.org
- Please allow up to 24 hours for a response on school days.
- In-person office hours: 2:45–3:15 p.m. (M–F) in Room B25

Empowered to Succeed, Guided by Faith